

Streamlining IT Procurement

Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Platform: ServiceNow

Module: Service Catalog / Flow Designer

Project Type: Micro Project

Core Topics: Flow Designer, Service Catalog, Catalog Task, Approval Workflow

PROJECT DETAILS

Item	Details
Project Title	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Platform	ServiceNow
Automation Tool	Flow Designer
Service Catalog Item	Standard Laptop
Flow Name	Standard laptop task
Application	Global
Run User	System user
Trigger	Service Catalog
Action	Create Catalog Task
Assignment Group	Hardware

ABSTRACT

This project presents an automated workflow for standard laptop procurement and configuration using ServiceNow Flow Designer. The project addresses delays and manual overhead in handling standard laptop requests. The proposed workflow creates a Catalog Task after the service request is approved, updates the task with the required short description and description, and assigns the task to the Hardware assignment group. The objective is to ensure that standard laptop configuration tasks are generated consistently and promptly, reducing manual intervention and improving the efficiency of IT procurement operations.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Introduction
2. Problem Statement
3. User Story
4. Project Objectives
5. Brainstorming and Ideation Phase
6. Requirement Analysis Phase
7. Project Design Phase
8. Project Planning Phase
9. Project Development Phase
10. Project Testing Phase
11. Project Documentation Phase
12. Project Demonstration Phase
13. Expected Benefits
14. Limitations
15. Conclusion
16. References

1. INTRODUCTION

IT procurement processes frequently involve multiple activities between the submission of a hardware request and the final configuration of the requested equipment. In a manual process, the creation and assignment of configuration tasks may depend on human intervention. The SmartBridge project focuses on improving this process for standard laptop requests by using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

The solution uses a Service Catalog trigger and a Create Catalog Task action. Once the relevant service request reaches the approved state, the workflow creates a Catalog Task with predefined information and assigns the task to the Hardware group. This creates a structured workflow from request submission through configuration-task generation.

2. PROBLEM STATEMENT

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, particularly when handling standard laptop orders. Standard laptop requests may require configuration before the device can be provided to the user. In a manual process, this configuration step may be overlooked or delayed. Such delays can increase user waiting time and create additional manual work for the IT department.

The project therefore addresses the need for an automated process that can generate the required configuration task after approval and route the task to the appropriate Hardware team.

3. USER STORY

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration. This ensures that laptops can be configured promptly after arrival, reduces user waiting time, and minimises manual intervention.

4. PROJECT OBJECTIVES

1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

5. BRAINSTORMING AND IDEATION PHASE

5.1 Identification of the Existing Problem

The initial brainstorming focuses on the manual effort involved in standard laptop procurement. The main issue is that a configuration task may need to be created and assigned after the service request has been approved. If this activity is handled manually, it can introduce delays and inconsistency.

5.2 Proposed Idea

The proposed idea is to use ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate the creation of a Catalog Task for Standard Laptop requests. The flow will be associated with the Standard Laptop service catalog item and will create the task with the required information when the request is approved.

5.3 Proposed Workflow

User → Standard Laptop Service Catalog → Request → Approval → Flow Designer → Catalog Task → Hardware Team → Laptop Configuration

5.4 Expected Outcome

- Automatic creation of the configuration task.
- Consistent task information.
- Automatic assignment to the Hardware group.
- Reduced manual effort.
- Reduced waiting time for users.

6. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS PHASE

6.1 Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement
FR-01	The workflow shall be implemented using ServiceNow Flow Designer.
FR-02	The flow shall be named Standard laptop task.
FR-03	The Application shall be Global.
FR-04	Run user shall be System user.
FR-05	The trigger shall be Service Catalog.
FR-06	The action shall be Create Catalog Task.
FR-07	Requested Item Record shall be mapped to Request item.
FR-08	Short description shall be Laptop need to Configured.
FR-09	Description shall be Laptop need to Configured.
FR-10	Assignment group shall be Hardware.
FR-11	Approval shall be Approved.
FR-12	The flow shall be saved and activated.
FR-13	The flow shall be assigned to the Standard Laptop service catalog item.
FR-14	A Standard Laptop request shall be placed for validation.
FR-15	The resulting Catalog Task shall be inspected.

6.2 Non-Functional Requirements

- The workflow should reduce manual overhead.
- Task allocation should be consistent.
- The workflow should be simple to maintain.
- The implementation should be testable through the Service Catalog.

6.3 Actors

- Requester/User
- Approver
- IT Procurement Process
- Hardware Team
- ServiceNow Administrator

7. PROJECT DESIGN PHASE

7.1 System Architecture

The system follows a simple event-driven workflow in ServiceNow.

Stage	Component	Purpose
1	User / Requester	Initiates a Standard Laptop request.
2	Service Catalog	Provides the Standard Laptop catalog item.
3	Approval	The request is approved before the configuration task is generated.
4	Flow Designer	Runs the Standard laptop task workflow.
5	Create Catalog Task	Creates the configuration task.
6	Hardware Group	Receives the task for laptop configuration.

7.2 Flow Properties

Property	Configured Value
Flow Name	Standard laptop task
Application	Global
Run User	System user
Trigger	Service Catalog

Action	Create Catalog Task
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7.3 Action Mapping

Field	Value / Mapping
Request item	Requested Item Record
Short description	Laptop need to Configured
Description	Laptop need to Configured
Assignment group	Hardware
Approval	Approved

7.4 Service Catalog Integration

The Standard Laptop service catalog item is configured through Maintain Items. Under Process Engine, the remaining automations are removed and the newly created Standard Laptop Task flow is added. This connects the service catalog item with the automation workflow.

8. PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

8.1 Milestones

Milestone	Description
Milestone 1 – Flow	Create and activate the Standard laptop task flow.
Milestone 2 – Flow Assignment	Assign the flow to the Standard Laptop service catalog item.
Milestone 3 – Service Catalog	Place a Standard Laptop order and validate the generated Catalog Task.

8.2 Work Plan

5. Create the Flow Designer flow.
6. Configure the Service Catalog trigger.
7. Configure the Create Catalog Task action.
8. Map the required fields.
9. Save and activate the flow.
10. Assign the flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item.
11. Place a Standard Laptop request.
12. Approve the request.
13. Inspect the resulting Catalog Task.

8.3 Team Structure

The SmartBridge instructions require teams to contain a minimum of 2 members, with a standard team size of 4 and a maximum of 5 members. The actual student names and responsibilities should be entered in the project team details document after the team is formed.

9. PROJECT DEVELOPMENT PHASE

9.1 Milestone 1 – Create the Flow

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click All and search for Flow Designer.
3. Open Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. Click New and select Flow.
5. Set the Flow Name to Standard laptop task.
6. Set Application to Global.
7. Select System user as the Run user.
8. Click Submit.
9. Click Add a trigger.
10. Search for Service Catalog and select it.
11. Click Done.
12. Under Actions, click Add an action.
13. Search for Create Catalog Task and select it.
14. Select Create Catalog Task as the action.
15. Drag and drop Requested Item Record into Request item.
16. Verify that the table is automatically populated as Catalog Task.
17. Set Short description to Laptop need to Configured.
18. Add the Description field and set it to Laptop need to Configured.

19. Set Assignment group to Hardware.
20. Set Approval to Approved.
21. Leave remaining fields at their default values.
22. Click Done.
23. Save the Flow.
24. Click Activate and confirm activation.

9.2 Milestone 2 – Flow Assignment

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click All and search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Search for Standard Laptop under the Name field.
5. Open the Standard Laptop record.
6. Select Process Engine.
7. Remove the remaining automations.
8. Add the flow named Standard Laptop Task.
9. Save the record.

9.3 Milestone 3 – Service Catalog Execution

1. Click All and search for Service Catalog.
2. Open Service Catalog and select Hardware.
3. Find and select Standard Laptop.

4. Click Order Now.
5. Open the Order Status.
6. Click the Request Number.
7. Open the Requested record.
8. Scroll to the Approvers section.
9. Approve the request.
10. Open the Requested Item section.
11. Open the Requested Item record.
12. Scroll to the Catalog Tasks section.
13. Open the Catalog Task.

10. PROJECT TESTING PHASE

10.1 Testing Objective

Testing is performed to confirm that the Standard Laptop request follows the expected workflow and that the Catalog Task is generated with the required values after approval.

Test ID	Test Activity	Expected Result
TC-01	Open Flow Designer	Flow Designer opens successfully.
TC-02	Verify flow name	Standard laptop task is displayed.
TC-03	Verify trigger	Service Catalog trigger is configured.
TC-04	Verify action	Create Catalog Task action is configured.
TC-05	Verify short description	Required short description is displayed.
TC-06	Verify description	Required description is displayed.
TC-07	Verify assignment group	Hardware is selected.
TC-08	Verify approval	Approved is selected.
TC-09	Verify activation	Flow is active.
TC-10	Place Standard Laptop order	Request is created.
TC-11	Approve request	Request is approved.
TC-12	Inspect Catalog Task	Catalog Task is generated.
TC-13	Verify final values	Short description and Hardware assignment are correct.

10.2 Test Evidence

Actual screenshots should be captured during execution and stored in the project assets folder. The final testing table should be updated with the actual result and status after execution.

10.3 Defect Log

Defect ID	Description	Severity	Resolution	Status
D-001	To be recorded during actual execution	-	-	Not Started

11. PROJECT DOCUMENTATION PHASE

11.1 Complete Workflow Description

The completed solution begins when a user accesses the Service Catalog and selects the Standard Laptop item under Hardware. The user places the order, and the request enters the approval process. After the request is approved, the configured Flow Designer workflow creates a Catalog Task. The task receives the Requested Item Record, the predefined short description and description, the Hardware assignment group, and the Approved value. The Hardware team can then use the generated task for configuration activities.

11.2 Expected Final Output

The final output is a Catalog Task associated with the Standard Laptop request. The task should show the configured short description and description and should be assigned to the Hardware group. The task record provides evidence that the automation has executed successfully.

11.3 Project Benefits

- Timely configuration task creation.
- Reduced manual intervention.
- Reduced potential for missed configuration tasks.
- Consistent task information.
- Improved task allocation.
- Improved IT procurement efficiency.

12. PROJECT DEMONSTRATION PHASE

12.1 Demonstration Requirements

The demonstration should be recorded as a complete project video. The video should include screen sharing, the student's voice-over or explanation, the project name, the purpose of the project, the use and benefits of the project, the project execution and working process, and the final output.

12.2 Demonstration Sequence

- 1.Introduce the project name.
- 2.Explain the problem statement.
- 3.Explain the purpose and objectives.
- 4.Open ServiceNow.
- 5.Show the Standard laptop task flow in Flow Designer.
- 6.Show the Service Catalog trigger.
- 7.Show the Create Catalog Task action.
- 8.Show the field mappings.
- 9.Show that the flow is activated.
- 10.Open the Standard Laptop service catalog item.
- 11.Place the order.
- 12.Open the Request Number.
- 13.Show the approval section.

14. Approve the request.

15. Open the Requested Item.

16. Open the Catalog Task.

17. Show the final status, short description and Hardware assignment.

18. Explain the final result and benefits.

12.3 Suggested Voice-Over

Hello, this is our project titled Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer. The purpose of this project is to automate the creation and assignment of a configuration task for a Standard Laptop request after approval. The solution uses ServiceNow Flow Designer with a Service Catalog trigger and a Create Catalog Task action. The generated task is assigned to the Hardware group and contains the required task description. This reduces manual intervention and supports a more efficient laptop procurement and configuration process.

12.4 Demo Video Link

Google	Drive	Demo	Video	Link:
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13. EXPECTED BENEFITS

1. Seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops.

2. Timely generation of configuration tasks.
3. Reduced manual intervention and potential errors.
4. Optimised task allocation to the Hardware group.
5. Improved IT procurement efficiency.
6. Reduced user waiting time.

14. LIMITATIONS

The provided SmartBridge project document specifically describes the ServiceNow Flow Designer workflow for standard laptop requests. It does not specify implementation details for external procurement systems, inventory management, payment processing, or external notification services. Therefore, those features are outside the defined scope of this project report.

15. CONCLUSION

The project implements a structured automation workflow for Standard Laptop procurement using ServiceNow Flow Designer. The workflow is designed to create a Catalog Task after approval, populate the required task information, and assign the task to the Hardware group. By automating this activity, the solution addresses the manual overhead and potential delays identified in the problem statement. The final workflow provides a clear and repeatable process from Standard Laptop request through approval and configuration-task generation.